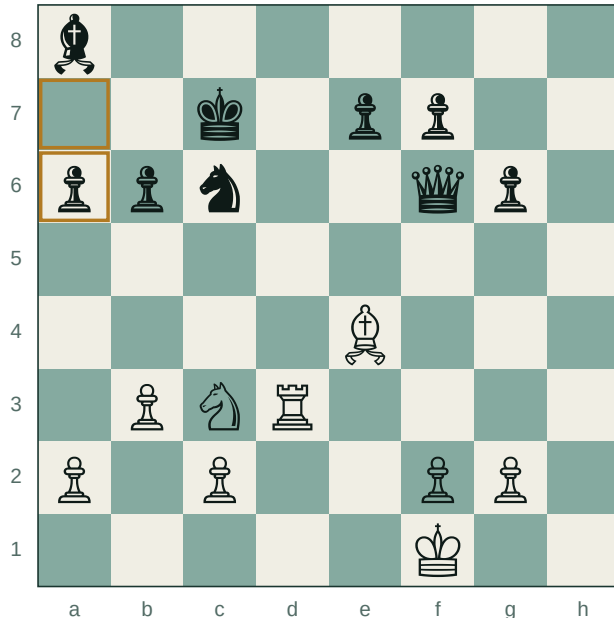


Forks and double attacks: White, move 27

Forks and double attacks

White to move



Previous move: 26...a6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

27. Nd5+ Kb8 28. Nxf6

27.Nd5+ Check restricts Black to 6 legal replies here. From d5 it attacks king on c7 and queen on f6. Recorded reply: **27...Kb8**.

28.Nxf6 The knight captures the queen on f6. The changed line means the bishop on e4 attacks the knight on c6.

At the end, nominal material is White 16 / Black 11 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +9: the balance goes from -4 to +5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Two attacked pieces do not guarantee a gain if the forking piece can be captured or one target moves with check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A fork attacks multiple targets at once. The combination works when the defender cannot save everything or generate a stronger forcing reply.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for checking forks first, then double attacks on queens, rooks, and undefended pieces. Follow the line until the material is actually collected.

The defending king is on c7. Geometrically undefended: bishop on a8. Check for tactical protection.